BRAIN 02

Armodafinil

Wakefulness-promoting drug taken by mouth; the R form (one mirror-image form) of modafinil



CLASS Wakefulness-promoting agent

STUDIED FOR Sleepiness: OSA, narcolepsy, shift work

HUMAN EVIDENCE Large trials; FDA approved

US STATUS FDA approved (Nuvigil) · Schedule IV

STUDIED FOR

- Sleep apnea sleepiness — HUMAN
- Narcolepsy — HUMAN
- Shift work disorder — HUMAN
- Jet lag — HUMAN
- Brain-tumor fatigue — HUMAN

HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

Armodafinil ▶ Dopamine carrier ▶ Less reuptake ▶ Wakefulness

- **Label:** how it promotes wakefulness is unknown
- **In lab studies,** binds the dopamine transporter and blocks dopamine reuptake
- **In mice** lacking that transporter, modafinil did not promote wakefulness
- Actions in **animal and lab studies** are similar to modafinil's

EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

EVIDENCE

FDA APPROVED
LEVEL 5 OF 5

- 12-week placebo trials in OSA, narcolepsy, shift work
- FDA approved 2007 (Nuvigil)
- Jet lag and glioma fatigue trials: off-label

NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- Use in children (not studied)

QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

HALF-LIFE About 15 hours (label)

ROUTES STUDIED Oral tablets (label)

PHARMACOKINETICS Peak in about 2 hours fasted; partly cleared by CYP3A4/5

SOLD AS Prescription tablets (Nuvigil); Schedule IV

MONITORED IN TRIALS Heart rate, blood pressure; rash; psychiatric symptoms

SPORT (WADA) Prohibited in competition, class S6 (as modafinil isomer)

REGULATORY

FDA	Approved (Nuvigil, 2007)
DEA	Schedule IV controlled substance
TGA	Approved; prescription-only (Schedule 4)
WADA	Prohibited in competition (S6.A, modafinil)

REFERENCES

1. FDA (DailyMed), Nuvigil prescribing information, May 2025
2. Mayo Clin Proc, armodafinil for jet lag, Phase 3, Jul 2010
3. WADA, 2026 Prohibited List

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